

OFF-CAMPUS TECH 2026

5 Things Indian Freshers Should **Delete** from Their Resumes

Why your college placement biodata format is getting ignored by off-campus tech recruiters (and what to put instead).

Based on recruiter workflows, ATS text parsing tests, and 2026 hiring standards.

REMOVE THIS

1. Father's Name & Family Biodata

WHY IT HURTS YOU:

Recruiters evaluate your technical skills, not family genealogy. In off-campus tech hiring, parent details are viewed as 1990s biodata clutter that wastes 2–3 lines of vertical space.

WHAT TO PUT INSTEAD:

Your clean **GitHub**, **LinkedIn**, and **Portfolio** links. Reclaim that space for real code evidence.

LEGITIMATE EXCEPTION:

Keep only if specifically mandated in formal Indian Government / PSU / UPSC exam applications.

REMOVE THIS

2. The Formal "Declaration" Block

WHY IT HURTS YOU:

"I hereby declare that all the information above is true to the best of my knowledge..." + Date + Place + Signature block wastes 4–5 lines of prime bottom space.

WHAT TO PUT INSTEAD:

Submitting an application legally implies truthfulness. Replace this wasted space with an extra technical certification or another project bullet.

LEGITIMATE EXCEPTION:

Physical paper document submissions for traditional banking/defense exams where signed hard copies are required.

REMOVE THIS

3. Headshot / Candidate Photo

WHY IT HURTS YOU:

Off-campus software and corporate hiring does not evaluate physical appearance. Photos can confuse optical text parsers and risk introducing unconscious hiring bias.

WHAT TO PUT INSTEAD:

A clean, centered text header with your **Full Name, City & State, Email, and Active Mobile (+91)**.

LEGITIMATE EXCEPTION:

Hospitality, aviation (cabin crew), media/acting, or European CV standards (e.g. Germany/France) where photos are conventional.

REMOVE THIS

4. Subjective Skill Rating Bars

WHY IT HURTS YOU:

Canva progress bars like *"Python: 85%"* or *"Problem Solving: ★★★★★☆"* mean nothing to technical interviewers. *"85% of what? Did you build the Python compiler?"*

WHAT TO PUT INSTEAD:

Categorized skills: **Languages, Frameworks, Tools,** and **Core CS Fundamentals**. Let your projects prove your skill level.

SENIOR ENGINEER RULE:

Never rate yourself subjectively on a resume. Only list technologies you have written code in and can defend in a live technical screen.

REMOVE THIS

5. Full Street / House Door Address

WHY IT HURTS YOU:

Putting your house number, street name, and local landmark creates unnecessary privacy risks when uploading resumes across dozens of job portals.

WHAT TO PUT INSTEAD:

Simply state City, State (e.g. *Bengaluru, Karnataka* or *Hyderabad, Telangana*). Recruiters only need to know your general location and relocation willingness.

WHEN ADDRESS IS NEEDED:

Keep full physical address for background checks and physical onboarding *after* receiving an official offer letter.

THE 1-PAGE PAYOFF

What Happens When You Cut the Fluff?

You immediately reclaim **8 to 12 lines of vertical space**. Fill that space with what actually gets you shortlisted:

- 2–3 substantive projects with live demo & GitHub links.
- Action verbs: *Engineered, Architected, Optimized*.
- Scope metrics: *Test coverage %, latency reduction, dataset size*.
- A clean single-column layout designed to reduce common parsing and text-order risks.

100% FREE • ₹0 UPFRONT

Need a Clean, ATS-Conscious Resume Template?

We compiled the **Fresher Job Application Kit (Free MVP v0.1)**:

- ✓ Single-Column .docx Template (Zero layout tables)
- ✓ Visual 1-Page Reference PDF
- ✓ 20-Point Resume Self-Audit Checklist
- ✓ 10-Minute Job Description Tailoring Worksheet
- ✓ Naukri Profile & Scam Defense Checklist
- ✓ Project Bullet Formula & Excel Application Tracker

Zero Paywalls. No Credit Card. Free Download.

Check the link in the first comment or profile bio.